SymbioNet:

Connecting Recent Graduates with Small Businesses

Project-based learning with supervision and real impact

THE CHALLENGE

Entry level jobs require 3+ years of experience

Poor entry-level job availability for recent graduates - you need experience to gain experience

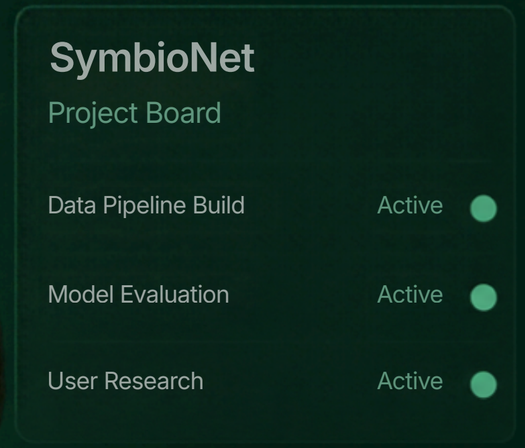
Small businesses need affordable, practical project support

> ***The Entry-Level Access Paradox***

Meet Maya — Navigating the Entry-Level Access Paradox

AI is shrinking traditional entry-level roles, yet most openings still require 3+ years of experience.

SymioNet gives Maya supervised, paid project experience — the bridge from potential to proven.



1 GRADUATE

Concordia University computer science graduate with no tangible work experience.

2 SUPERVISED PROJECT VIA SYMBIONET

Matched with a supervisor and team to deliver real impact on paid projects.

3 DEMONSTRABLE EXPERIENCE

Builds a portfolio of delivered work and confidently unlocks what's next.

Supervised. Supported. Impact driven.

SymbioNet in Action

Maya & Nicolas matched with Supervisory Support

MAYA

GRADUATE

Delivers project work and builds real-world impact with guidance and feedback.

SymbioNet

Connected, Supported. Impact driven.

NICOLAS

SMALL BUSINESS OWENER
SUDS AND SUN

Hosts the intern and posts a project, context and feedback.

SUPERVISOR

INDEPENDENT OVERSIGHT

Validates milestones, provides quality assurance and ensures the project meets learning and impact expectations.

1 — **PROJECT START APPROVAL**

2 — **MID-PROJECT REVIEW**

3 — **PROJECT COMPLETION APPROVAL**

Supervisor Checkpoints

Milestone	Status	Notes
Project completion approval	Pending review	Final deliverables submitted

FUNDING CONTEXT

These are precedents and proposed contexts, not SymbioNet awards.

YESS: $307,9M over 2 years starting 2026-27

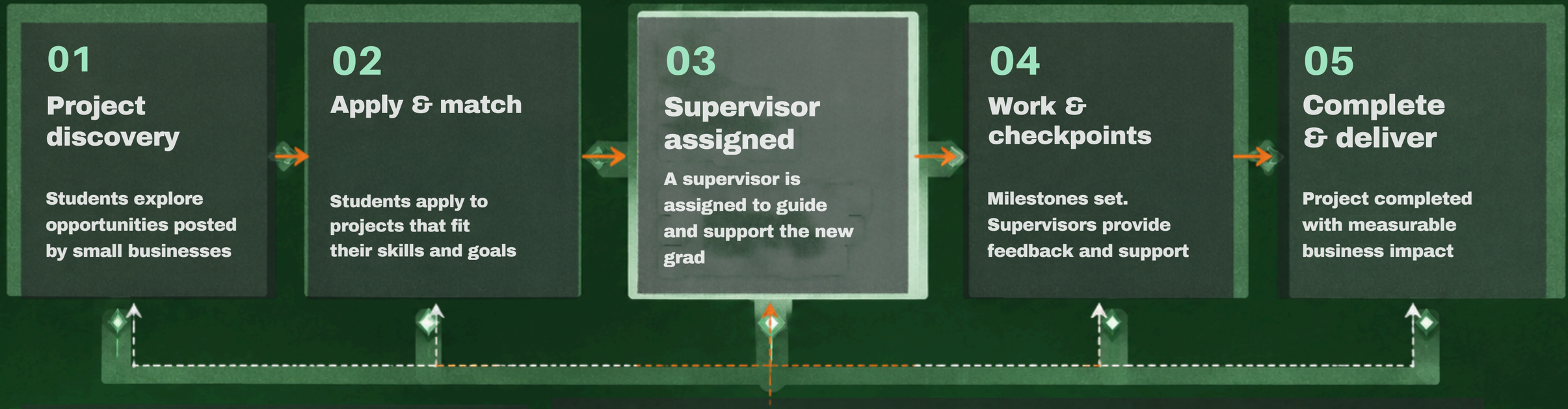
DS4Y: $11.9M annually for 2026-27 & 2027-28

DS4Y funding up to $30,000 per internship including 100% wage subsidy

Supervisor subsidy would require design and approval; not an established DS4Y entitlement.

WORKFLOW & SUPERVISION MODEL

A CLEAR PATH TO IMPACT, GUIDED SUPPORT EVERY STEP OF THE WAY



STUDENTS

Discover opportunities, apply, and contribute their skills to real business challenges

SUPERVISORS

Monitor progress, ensure quality, and keep projects on track toward successful delivery

SYMBIONET SOLUTION OVERVIEW

The solution

A platform that connects recent graduates with small business projects that need solving.

The impact

Students build real-world experience and gain mentorship.

Small businesses get practical solutions to real challenges.

Supervisors guide work and drive results.